



www.katherineroot.com | linkedin.com/in/katherineroot | keroot@gmail.com | Mountain View, CA

Product design leader with 14+ years spanning IC, Director, and Head of Design roles. Built an AI-native health product from 0-to-1, growing weekly active users roughly 5x post-launch, and scaled teams, design systems, and processes at a rapid-growth company. Background in consumer-focused, human-centered design.

EXPERIENCE

Head of Design

Manta Cares | Hybrid | May 2025 - Jul 2026

Leading product and experience design in a small team, AI-native, 0-to-1 startup environment, building apps to support patients navigating cancer. Collaborated with healthcare providers, pharma partners, and clinical teams to ground the product in medical rigor while keeping the experience accessible and human.

Simplified product feature set to reduce noise, sustaining conversions of 88–96%. Designed and launched iOS and Android apps, driving 792 first-time downloads in the first 6 months live. Led design and go-to-market of HopeAI, an AI guide within Manta Cares. Grew weekly active users roughly 5x post-launch and reached 1,408 distinct patients within 5 months, with about half of all conversations continuing past a single exchange.

Shaped a new company brand identity that carries Manta Cares into clinical and oncology communities, extending it through print and physical materials for a cohesive experience.

Director of Design

Mighty Networks | Remote | Jul 2020 - May 2025

Defining and implementing an innovative product vision during a critical period of growth following our Series B. Continuously pushing our user experience to be more focused, more delightful, and more meaningful as we aim to bring People Magic to online communities.

Contributing individual design work on critical projects, while supporting a healthy team environment. Spearheading the creation of a cohesive cross-platform design system for mobile (iOS and Android) and web applications, evangelizing the strategic role of product design across the company, implementing human-centered design methodologies across all projects, and collaborating with C-Suite to define product strategy and development cycles.

Hiring, scaling, and maintaining a design team as large as 8, establishing remote-based design workflows, reviewing and critiquing design deliverables, mentoring team members, and fostering a culture of innovation and continuous learning.

Senior Product Designer | Mighty Networks | Palo Alto, CA | 2018 - 2020

Product Designer | Mighty Networks | Palo Alto, CA | 2015 - 2018

Product Designer | Simply Hired | Sunnyvale, CA | 2014 - 2015

Product Design Consultant | CircleBlack | Remote | 2014

Lead Interaction Designer | Copper | San Mateo, CA | 2013

Interaction Designer | Launch Design | Los Altos, CA | 2012

TOOLS



Claude



Figma



Arc



Slack



Lovable



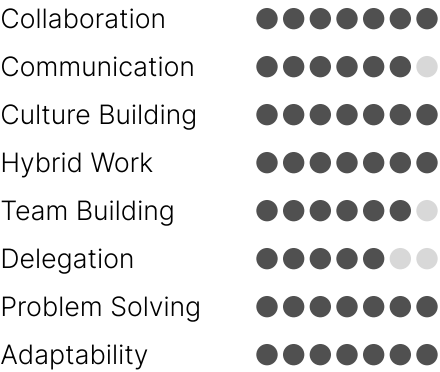
Granola

SKILLS

Design



Leadership



EDUCATION

University of Washington
Seattle, WA | 2008 - 2012

BS Informatics
Focus, Human-Computer Interaction
Minor, Interaction Design

Middle Path Leadership Training
Palo Alto, CA | 2021 - Present

Leading 1:1
DiSC, Working Effectively with Others
Offsite Design and Facilitation